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The PHILATEX

A.P.S. Ch. # 53-0388 sastamps.org T.P.A. Life Ch. # 3

MEETING CALENDAR 2022

MARCH			APRIL		
4	BOG & Meeting "Show & Tell"	7:00 pm 7:30 pm	1	BOG & Meeting "Show & Tell"	7:00 pm 7:30 pm
11	Auction - Come at 7 to browse (set-up at 6:30 - no lots after 7:15)	7:30 pm	8	Auction - Come at 7 to browse (set-up at 6:30-no lots after 7:15)	7:30 pm
18	Program: "US Possessions" by Steve Mabie	7:30 pm	15	No Meeting HAPPY EASTER - APRIL 17	
25	Bourse & Bags – buy, sell & trade, & Bag Night! (set-up at 6:30 pm)	7:30 pm	22	Program: "Surprise Program" by Al Lozano	7:30 pm
21 31	Spring Equinox Fiesta - March31 - April 10		29	Bourse & Bags – buy, sell & trade, & Bag Night! (set-up at 6:30 pm)	7:30 pm
May: 06-Show & Tell; 13-Auction; 20-Bourse & Bag Night; 27-No meeting - Memorial day					

EDITOR'S CORNER - Why is Easter so late in 2022?

Easter is always on the first Sunday after the first full moon that follows the Spring Equinox. So there you go – in 2022 the first full moon after the March 21 Spring Equinox is – Saturday, April 16, hence why Easter is on Sunday, April 17.

LEA SENGHAAS & DORA ROBERTS

Lady Lorraine

On Tuesday, January 18, 2022, this quilt was presented to "Rodie" and Tom Cruthers. "Rodie" plays guitar with a country and western group on Tuesday afternoons from 1:30 to 3:30 at Bar-B-Q Station.

This is the second time the quilt has been won. When it was sold by the Quilters at the church, my son, Gregg won it the day after he passed away. We were going to send it to Gregg's brother in Fort Worth, but I decided to put it on sale for the Jrs.

When the quilt was put on sale for the church school it netted $5,000 and when it was put on sale for the Jrs., it netted $1,000. All-in-all, this quilt has earned a total of $6,000 for young people.

By the way, Tom Cruthers in 6'8" tall. The Cruthers tell me that the quilt has been very warm and it stretched Tom's full length.

Yours in Philately, Pat Richmond

PHILATEX: Editors Lea Senghaas & Dora Roberts
Labels Fred Groth
Mailing Jack Virta

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c/o Al Lozano
13530 FM 1560N
Helotes, TX 78023

SAPA meets at MacArthur Park Lutheran Church, 2903 Nacogdoches Rd, every Friday night at 7:30 pm in Bldg. #1, facing Nacogdoches Rd. Yearly dues are $20.00, prorated.

ELECTED OFFICERS:

President:	Chip Swinney
Vice President:	Al Lozano
Secretary:	Pat Richmond
Treasurer:	Fred Groth
Membership Chairman:	Dora Roberts
Communications Chairman:	Brittany Roberts
Historian:	Fred Groth
Auctioneer:	Chip Swinney
Assistant Auctioneer:	Steve Mabie

BOARD OF GOVERNORS:

Board President:	Chip Swinney
All Elected Officers:	(see above)
Past President:	RIP Dr. Eric Shepard
One year term:	Lea Senghaas
Two year term:	Nancy Mabie
Parliamentarian:	Harry Greer
Honorary Board Member	Jack Virta

APPOINTED:

Auditing Committee: Tony Bir (Chairman)

LIAISON CONTACT PERSONS:

American Philatelic Society:	Fred Groth
Austin-Texas Stamp Club:	Lyle Boardman
Texas Philatelic Association:	Dr. Eric Shepard
APS Circuit Books:	Steve Mabie

WE WELCOME VISITORS

Please view our website **sastamps.org** for information on our meeting schedules

SAPA is always happy to welcome visitors. We hope you will enjoy our activities and wish to join us as members.

All visitors are welcome to purchase stamps at our auctions, bourses and bag nights. Anyone wishing to sell or trade at our meetings must be a member.

AUCTION ETIQUETTE :

Be sure to get your Bidder's number card before the auction starts. Come early and look over the lots for sale before the auction. During the auction, lots will be identified by their lot number and a brief description of the lot.

When bidding for a lot, please raise your Bidder's Number card and keep it up until you no longer wish to bid. Flipping the card up and down is confusing for the auctioneers.

Please keep extraneous conversation to a minimum. This makes it easier for everyone to hear what the auctioneer is selling, and allows the auctioneer to more easily keep track of the bidding.

While your purchases will be given to you during the auction, please wait until the end of the auction to pay for them. Your name will be called as the tallys are completed. Those who are only buying will be called first. Buyers who are also sellers will be called next. Checks made out to S.A.P.A. are acceptable. Sellers with unsold lots should be sure to pick up their lots before leaving.

Please be sure to return the Bidder's Number cards so that we can use them again in the following auctions.

We look forward to meeting you.

UPCOMING SHOWS & BOURSES

April 8-9 - Dallas TSDA - Doubletree Hotel - Bluebonnet Room, 1981 North Central Expressway, (Hwy 75 & Campbell Rd), Richardson, TX 75080 Friday 10-5, Saturday 9-4. Driving directions, if needed, can be obtained at www.mapquest.com.

TSDA - https://www.tsdastamps.com is the Texas Stamp Dealers Association's website. If you wish to attend any show listed for them in our newsletter, please check this site to make sure the show is going forward, and has not been cancelled for any reason.

Program Notes

March 18 - "U.S. Possessions" by Steve Mabee

Well, Steve has told me that he wants to give his program on his collection of "U.S. Possessions" on stamps and covers. He has given us good programs in the past about U.S. Revenues and Graf Zeppelins. I am relatively sure that his program on the 18th will interesting and educational. OK, Steve the stage is yours. We will be looking forward to your program.

April 22 - "Surprise Program" by Al Lozano

Al has graciously consented to give us a "Surprise Program" on his Birthday! He is going to share some things that he likes to collect. I, for one, am looking forward to his surprise. Happy Birthday, Al!!! It's your turn to show us some surprises!

Yours in Philately, Pat Richmond

SA&ST POSTCARD CLUB

The San Antonio and South Texas Postcard Club meetings are held on the third Monday of each month. Our next three meetings will be held on March 21, April 18, and May 16. The postcard club is open to anyone who collects or is simply interested in postcards. The annual membership dues are $10.00.

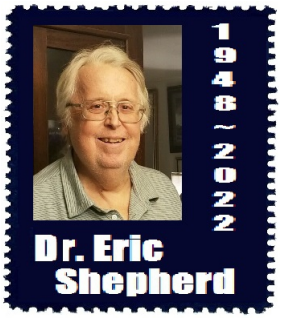
Meetings are held at the Dwyer Center of the San Antonio Genealogical & Historical Society, 903 Melissa Drive. The Dwyer Center is on the corner of Blanco Road & Melissa Drive, about one mile outside Loop 410.

We start gathering at 6:30 to talk, buy, sell, and trade postcards. Our meetings start at 7:00 pm. Each meeting usually includes a short presentation by a member on some segment of his or her postcard collection.

We also hold a monthly contest for the best representative postcard that matches the category of the month. On March 21 the postcard should be of "animals wearing clothes." The topic for April 18 is postcards showing "Fiesta or parades." On May 16, the postcards should show "mothers." For more information about the San Antonio and South Texas Postcard Club, contact the club secretary, Nancy Mabie, NRMabie@gmail.com.

If someone wants to receive email notifications when there is important information for club members, but does not want to have their email in the Philatex, please let Fred Groth know. He will make sure you keep informed, but will protect your privacy. Contact him at **LTC519@satx.rr.com** or phone him at 210-829-0323.

Closed Albums



Dr. Eric Shepherd was SAPA President from 2014 - 2020.

Eric grew up in Port Arthur, Texas, and was a 1966 graduate of Thomas Jefferson High School. In 1970, Eric graduated from Lamar University with a Bachelor of Science in Biology. After graduation, Eric proudly served four years of active duty in the U.S. Navy as a Hospital Corpsman and Lab Tech. In 1978, Eric earned his Bachelor of Science in Animal Science from Texas A&M, and in 1982, he obtained his Ph.D. in Food Science and Technology from Texas A&M.

Eric worked for 26 years as a civilian employee of the U.S. Army at Fort Sam Houston as a food chemist at the DOD Food Analysis and Diagnostic Laboratory. He retired in 2013.

Eric spent his retirement enjoying his favorite hobbies which included growing orchids, woodworking, & collecting stamps, rocks and shells. Eric loved traveling anywhere by train and he was also an avid reader.

He will be missed by everyone who knew him.

BAG NIGHT IS BACK!!!

Bag Night is returning to SAPA. At our request, the APA sent the club one large, flat-rate USPS Priority Mail "If it fits, it ships" box that is stuffed with stamps. The APA sold our club the box of stamps for just the price of shipping the stamps to SAPA. These stamps are worldwide stamps from a wide range of time periods. And the stamps are all "off paper." Steve & Nancy Mabie will be dividing the stamps into 20-30 lunch bag sized gift bags. These bags will be available once a month on the same night as the Bourse. On Bourse Nights, SAPA Members will be able to leisurely search through a bag or two. Each stamp you select to keep will cost 5¢. This is a great way to add to your collections and fatten the treasury of SAPA.

"National Air Mail Week 1938"

by Howard Wallace

Well, finally we got to have Howard's program. He was originally scheduled in 2019. Then the COVID disaster hit!!!!!! We are finally able to get back to normal (?) Well, it is not quite normal yet!!! Evidently not many showed up because of the weather. Unfortunately I was not able to attend, because I have a bad ear. Sorry, Howard.

Howard talked about the Special Week in 1938 that honored Air Mail.

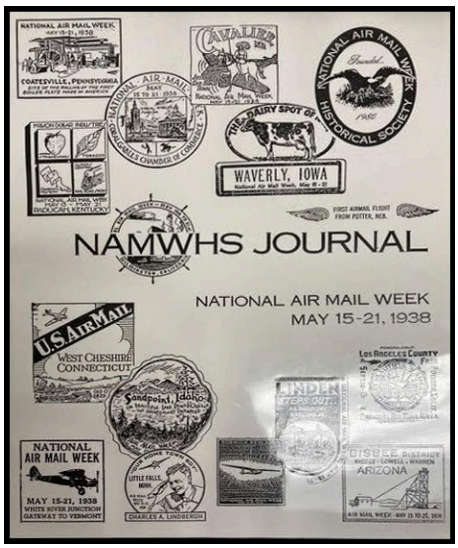
"I started collecting stamps and covers when I was 9 yers old. My Grandmother gave me her collection. In the collections was a set of NAMW covers adrressed to her sister – my Great Aunt, Agnes Wright Spring. She was the State Historian for Wyoming at that time. As for NAMW, it was the biggest nationally organized celebration of it's time. It may still hold that distinction to this day."

DETAILS. In February of 1938 a nation-wide public relations campaign was launched. The brainchild of Postmaster General James A. Farley, Air Mail Week – celebrating 20 years of air mail service in the U.S. - encouraged every U.S. citizen to send an airmail letter during May 15 to 21. The campaign had a catchy slogan: "Receive To-morrow's mail To-day!" Purposes: Recognition of air mail transportation progress since the first flight in 1918. Familiarize the public about the uses and advantages of air mail service. Publicize commercial aviation's ability to handle mail, express, and passengers Increase air mail usage, thereby growing postal revenue to support further air network expansion.

KEY PEOPLE & ORGANIZATIONS: James Farley – Postmaster General Harllee Branch – 2nd Asst. PMG Charles Graddick – Supt. Air Mail Service Paul Younts – National Chairman, NAMW Eleanor Roosevelt – First Lady, Postal Employee Organizations, Civic and Community Organizations, Chambers of Commerce, Airline Industry and Notable Fliers.

MAJOR ACTIVITIES: Six-Cents Air Mail Stamp (C-23) Issuance, National and Local Cachets, Commemorative and Special Flights, Air Mail Poster Contest "Wings Over America", Essay Contest for High School students (48 state winners flown to DC), Awards and Events Dinners,and National Radio Broadcasts.

ACCOMPLISHMENTS: More than 9,200 cachets were designed & 10,000 individual city cachets were prepared. There were 500,000+ entries in the essay contest, 1,700 volunteer pilots for May 19 feeder routes to network air-stop points. 15,000,000 air mail letters and 25,000 air parcels were sent between May 15th and 21st PMG Farley received 150,000+ air mailed congratulatory letters, parcels, and covers.



The NAMWHS Journal advertised the show in its issue. Howard had a copy for all to see.

On Saturday, May 14th, festivities for the celebration week were kicked off with the issuance of a new 6-cent Eagle multi-colored air mail stamp, Scott #C23. It was a special issue indeed, the stamp design itself was suggested from a sketch that was drawn by President Franklin D. Roosevelt. Postmasters were directed to bring to the attention of the public, Each town across the nation was invited to create its own cachet, a commemorative design or slogan that would be printed or stamped on the envelopes.

Civic Organizations and Businesses were encourage to particiapte. Chambers of Commerce were convinced to provide a budget for promtions since their local post offices were not allowed to spend $ from their normal budgets. These cachets were available for use the entire week, but most of the covers were mailed on Thursday, May 19th, As you can imagine, some of the cachets and handstamps were quite colorful and expertly designed, while some were hastily created and somewhat minimal. A number of 1938 NAMW events were staged between the dates of 15-21 May, with the 19th being the highlight day in which mail submitted by individuals would be flown on an airplane The airplanes would, for the most part, be privately owned and piloted by civilian pilot volunteers. They were sworn

in as volunteer government employees for 24 hours. The State and inter-State routes were temporarily established using various airstrips, airports, and temporary fields at which mailbags were quickly loaded before the pilot flew to the next pick up point. The complicated process of collecting, cancelling, flying, sorting and delivering a great quantity of air mail letters and parcels was executed with great precision. For certain cities, the pilot who carried the envelopes would autograph the covers, quite a few local Postmasters signed the covers. You will see samples of those from my collection.

Fortunately, only two of the special flights crashed. One was the flight from Messina, NY to Syracuse, NY. The other was the flight from Cheyenne, Wyoming to Lusk, Wyoming. The landing was rough and the plane nosed over. None of the covers from these crashes have additional markings.

That brings me to the covers my grandmother gave me. They are from Niobra County, Wyoming.To give you some idea of how organized some post offices and counties were, all fourteen post offices in the county of Niobrara, WY participated in the NAMW by using an individualized cachet. The post offices were shown on a county map which was pre printed on envelopes. The envelopes contained two foldout inserts The first provided a history of the Cheyenne and Black Hills Stage Line that ran the entire length of the county, south to north. The second insert was a description of the county, its attributes, services, industries, churches, and so on.

Postmaster Courtesy Slips: The imprint of a cachet was freely given by those post offices that used a rubber stamped cachet. These copies are referred to as: cachet proofs, postmaster samples/specimens and courtesy slips. Postmasters were also known to have signed some of their cachet courtesy slips. They also signed a small number of covers.

FINAL COMMENTS: According to PM James Farley, "NAMW was a complete success!" Even the dinner for the essay contest was a complete success. All participants flown in from each of the 48 states. Not one was late and all flown home safely.

INPLICATIONS: Post Office Department succeeded in mail transitioning to a by-product of air network services instead of its primary function. Societal objectives of the Roosevelt administration were promoted: stimulation of new business investment; cultivating optimism of a "better tomorrow" through technological improvements and coming prosperity; binding the nation through community goals.

Howard gave us a short history of airmail in the U.S.:

1910-1916 is called the Pioneer Period.

May 1918 with flights between New York, Philadelphia and Washington, D.C.

1926-1st year of Contact Air Mail(C.A.M.)

1928: CAM #2 (2/28) is a Lindberg flight cover with horseshoe design cachet.

1930's: 60 cities had an air mail field (A.M.F.)

1930's*: Flyby* pick up was popular, ended in early 1940's.

1938: May 15-21 was National Airmail Week. **This event lost popularity because too many covers were issued.**

1950: March first mail from Kalaupapa (leper colony) was fumigated before being sent on the first flight to the U.S.

F.A.M. stands for Foreign Airmail and was U.S. contracted.

Howard placed many covers on the table and everyone got to pick one.

Those people who attended the program enjoyed it immensely. I'm sorry I had to miss it Howard. Maybe we can have you back for another program and more people will attend. (Count on it ,Howard!!!)

Yours in Philately, Pat Richmond